

Velora Studio

AI Studio & Sales Engine for Indian Merchants on WhatsApp

Revised strategy · Inbound acquisition · Subscription model

Version 2.0 · July 2026

1. Executive Summary

Velora Studio is a B2B SaaS product built for Indian e-commerce sellers, home businesses, and local retail brands. The entire customer experience lives inside **WhatsApp** — no website onboarding, no design tools, no technical skills required.

Merchants upload a raw product photo, choose simple options via buttons (background, vibe, studio vs ad), and receive polished marketing-ready images in seconds. After **2 free studio shots**, they subscribe via Razorpay to unlock monthly credit balances.

Unfair advantage: Unlike passive SaaS that waits for signups, Velora is built as an **inbound conversion engine** — Meta/Instagram ads and referrals drive opted-in merchants to WhatsApp, where value is proven in under 60 seconds and subscriptions close in the same chat thread.

Strategic change from v1: Google Maps lead scraping and automated cold WhatsApp outreach are removed. Acquisition is 100% opt-in (ads, content, referrals, partnerships) for compliance, trust, and sustainable unit economics.

2. Revised Workflow (5 Stages)

Stage	Name	What happens
1	Acquire (opt-in)	Meta/Instagram ads, Reels, referrals, and partner channels drive merchants to Click-to-Chat on WhatsApp. User explicitly opts in.
2	Activate (60-second wow)	Welcome message → upload product photo → 3 background buttons → first studio result delivered in chat. No long interview on message one.
3	Guide (conversational)	OpenAI manages follow-up choices: vibe, studio vs social ad, optional headlines. Button-based — no text prompts required.
4	Generate (Potoroom)	Raw image + choices routed to Potoroom Plus API: background removal, AI scene, relighting. Ad mode adds copy + template layout (premium credit).
5	Convert & retain	After 2 free images, paywall + Razorpay payment link. Brand memory, festival packs, and referral credits drive retention and expansion.

3. Product Strategy

3.1 Core experience principles

- **WhatsApp-first:** Upload, choose, receive — all in chat.
- **Buttons over prompts:** Marble / Wood / Studio / Sunlight — no AI literacy needed.
- **Fast proof:** First result before any lengthy onboarding.
- **Honest marketing:** Promise “studio-quality product shots,” not unverified “4K” unless output is guaranteed.

3.2 Studio vs Social Media Ad fork

After the first image, the bot asks:

“Do you need a Normal Studio Photoshoot or a Social Media Ad Post?”

Mode	Output	Credit cost
Studio	Clean product on chosen background with professional lighting	1 studio credit
Ad post	Product + AI headline/sticker (e.g. “Festival Sale — 15% OFF”) on styled template	2 ad credits (higher API + OpenAI cost)

3.3 Free tier

- **2 free studio images** per phone number (lifetime or rolling — configurable).
- Ad mode available only after subscription or optional top-up pack.
- Quota balance visible in WhatsApp: *"Balance: 38 studio · 5 ad"*.

3.4 Brand memory (retention)

After 2nd generation, store lightweight preferences in database:

- Product category (jewellery, food, clothing, etc.)
- Preferred background and language (Hindi / English)
- Last used vibe and ad headline style

Enables faster repeat flows and festival campaign nudges (Diwali, Rakhi, wedding season).

3.5 Optional add-ons (post-MVP)

- **₹199 one-time pack:** 5 studio shots for hesitant non-subscribers.
- **Annual billing:** ~2 months free (e.g. Growth at ₹17,999/year) for cash flow.
- **Agency tier:** Multi-brand / white-label for listing agencies (+₹1,500/mo add-on).
- **Web dashboard:** OTP login, quota history, asset download — after 100+ paying users.

4. Go-to-Market (No Cold Scraping)

4.1 Primary acquisition channels

Channel	Tactic	Why it works
Meta / Instagram ads	"Try 2 free studio shots on WhatsApp" + Click-to-Chat	High intent, Meta-compliant opt-in, measurable CPA
Reels / Shorts	Before/after product transformations + bio link	Low-cost demos; visual product sells itself
Referrals	Invite a shop → both get +3 studio credits	Low CAC; strong in local merchant networks
Partnerships	Photographers, packaging vendors, Shopify/Woo agencies	Trusted distribution to ideal customer profile
Marketplace sellers	Content targeting Meesho/Amazon listing quality pain	Clear ROI story: better photos → more sales

4.2 What we deliberately avoid

- Google Maps scraping and unsourced phone lists
- Automated cold WhatsApp blasts to non-opted-in numbers
- Unlimited subscription tiers (margin risk)
- Heavy OpenAI "interview" before first image (kills activation)

4.3 Compliance

- Opt-in only; store consent timestamp per user
- Easy STOP / unsubscribe in every flow
- Meta-approved templates for any proactive messaging outside 24h window
- Respect TRAI / DND norms — no purchased lead lists

5. Financial Architecture & Subscription Tiers

Monthly subscription model with separate **studio** and **ad** credit pools. Margins benefit from industry-standard **usage breakage** (not all subscribers exhaust caps).

5.1 Recommended plans

Plan	Target market	Price (INR/mo)	Studio credits	Ad credits
Starter	Home bakers, boutique shops	₹999	40	5
Growth	D2C brands, Instagram sellers	₹1,799	80	12
Pro	E-commerce shops, small agencies	₹2,999	150	25

5.2 Unit economics (conservative)

Cost component	Estimate per asset
Studio image (Potoroom + light OpenAI)	₹6 – ₹9
Ad post (Potoroom + copy + layout)	₹10 – ₹14

Starter plan — full usage worst case:

$40 \times ₹8 + 5 \times ₹12 \approx \text{₹380 API cost}$ on ₹999 revenue → **~62% gross margin**.

Real-world margin is higher due to unused credits and partial ad usage.

5.3 Margin protection rules

- Ad mode costs 2× internally vs studio (reflected in separate ad credit pool).
- No unlimited plans at launch.
- Three tiers only — simple to sell and support.
- Track funnel: ad click → first photo → second photo → payment (for CPA optimization).

6. Technical Stack Blueprint

Layer	Technology	Role
App host	Next.js on Vercel	API routes, webhooks, sandbox tester
Database	Supabase (PostgreSQL)	Users, credits, conversations, generations, payments
Storage	Supabase Storage	Uploads and output PNGs
WhatsApp	Meta Cloud API (BSP later if needed)	Webhooks, media, interactive buttons
Conversation	OpenAI (gpt-4o-mini)	Session flow, ad copy generation
Graphics	Photoroom Plus API	Background removal, AI scenes, relighting
Payments	Razorpay payment links + webhooks	Subscription activation and credit grants

6.1 Build phases (current status)

Phase	Scope	Status
Phase 1	Photoroom sandbox, Supabase schema, health check, web tester	✅ Complete
Phase 2	Full WhatsApp flow: photo → buttons → generate → deliver → credits	📦 Next
Phase 3	Studio vs ad fork, OpenAI copy, template compositing	📦 Planned
Phase 4	Razorpay paywall, plan buttons, webhook credit grants	📦 Planned
Phase 5	Referrals, analytics funnel, dashboard, agency tier	📦 Future

7. Key Metrics to Track

- **Acquisition:** Cost per WhatsApp conversation (from Meta ads)
- **Activation:** % who upload first photo within 5 minutes
- **Conversion:** % who use both free images
- **Revenue:** Free → paid conversion rate; ARPU by plan
- **Retention:** Month-2 active rate; credits used vs granted (breakage)
- **Quality:** Regeneration rate; support tickets per 100 users

8. Summary — What Changed from Original Plan

Removed

- Google Maps lead harvesting
- Cold WhatsApp outreach to scraped numbers
- Long interview before first result
- Over-promising “4K” in marketing

Added

- Inbound ads + referrals + partnerships
- 60-second activation path
- Separate studio / ad credit pools
- Brand memory + festival campaigns
- Funnel analytics from day one

Next build step: Phase 2 — full WhatsApp conversation flow. WhatsApp-specific requirements to be finalized separately before implementation.